Elective surgery

Any non-emergency surgical procedure that may be scheduled at the patient's convenience without jeopardizing the patient's life or causing serious impairment to the patient's bodily functions.

Expense

An expense is "incurred" on the date the service or supply is rendered.

Experimental or investigational services

A medical, surgical, diagnostic, psychiatric, mental health, substance use disorder, or other healthcare service, technology, supply, treatment, procedure, drug, medication, device, or biological product (referred to as "service") is experimental or investigational if the Plan determines any of the following to apply:

1. A service which cannot be lawfully marketed without approval of the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) and approval for marketing has not been given for the proposed use or patient-specific diagnosis or condition at the time it is furnished.
2. Reliable evidence shows that it is the subject of ongoing phase I, II, or III clinical trials or under study to determine its maximum tolerated dose, its toxicity, its safety, its efficacy, or its efficacy as compared with the standard means of treatment or diagnosis for the proposed use or patient-specific diagnosis or condition.
3. Reliable evidence shows that the consensus of opinion among experts is that further studies or clinical trials are necessary to determine its maximum tolerated dose, its toxicity, its safety, its efficacy, or its efficacy as compared with the standard means of treatment or diagnosis.
4. Reliable evidence shows that the healthcare service does not improve health outcome, is not more beneficial as established alternative(s) for the proposed use or patient specific condition or diagnosis, service does not produce improvement outside of the research setting or is otherwise not consistent with generally accepted standards of medical practice in the United States.
5. Reliable evidence shall mean credible scientific evidence published in peer-reviewed medical literature generally recognized by the relevant medical community, nationally recognized evidence-based clinical guidelines and criteria from independent sources, national physician specialty society recommendations, and the views of medical practitioners practicing in relevant clinical areas, and any other relevant factors. Please refer to geha.com/Coverage-Criteria for details on the literature used in medical decision making.

Determination of experimental/investigational status may require review of appropriate government publications such as those of the National Institute of Health, National Cancer Institute, Agency for Healthcare Policy and Research, Food and Drug Administration, National Library of Medicine, the American Hospital Formulary Service, or the United States American Hospital Pharmacopoeia Dispensing Information. We reserve the right to consult expert opinion in determining whether healthcare services are Experimental or Investigational.

Group health coverage

Healthcare coverage that a member or covered dependent is eligible for because of employment by, membership in, or connection with, a particular organization or group that provides payment for hospital, medical, dental or other healthcare services or supplies, including extension of any of these benefits through COBRA.

Habilitative

Therapy is initiated to address a genetic, congenital, or early acquired disorder resulting in significant deficit of Activities of Daily Living (ADL), fine motor, or gross motor skills. Therapy services are provided to enhance functional status and are focused on developing skills that were never present.

Healthcare professional

A physician or other healthcare professional licensed, accredited, or certified to perform specified health services consistent with state law.